

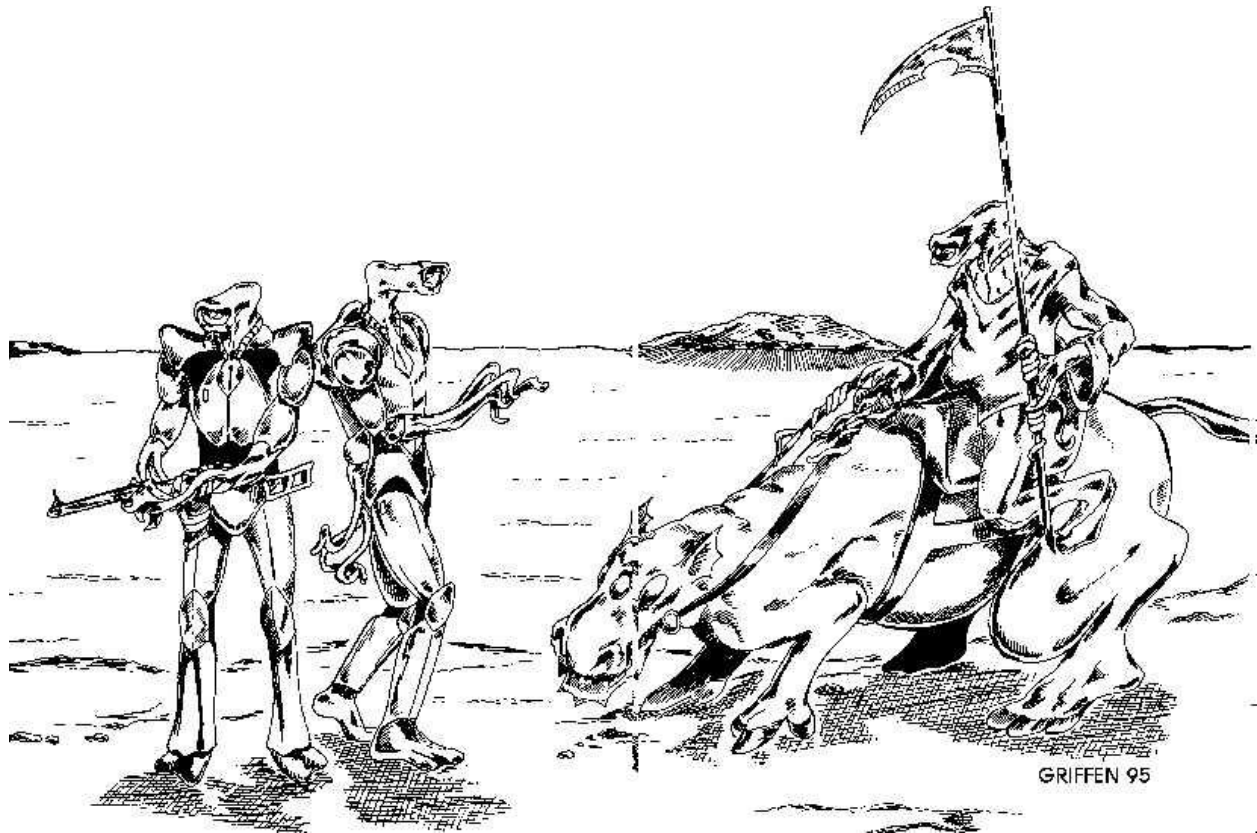
The Vegans (Tyui) of the Traveller Universe

Overview

The Vegans (or *Tyui*, as they call themselves) are a minor alien species in the *Traveller* RPG universe, known for their distinctive physiology, unique cultural institutions, and their presence within the Vegan Autonomous District. Though considered a “minor race” (having not developed jump drive independently), they play a meaningful role in interstellar society through their contributions to science, diplomacy, trade, and the arts.

Physiology and Appearance

Vegans are tall, slender, and somewhat plant-like in appearance, with elongated limbs and greenish-hued skin. Their specialized respiratory systems let them survive in low-oxygen environments, such as those found on their homeworld, Muan Gwi. This physiological adaptation shapes much of their environment, lifestyle, and architecture.



Vegan Worlds and Architecture

The core Vegan world is **Muan Gwi**, a low-gravity (0.5g), arid planet with a thin atmosphere. Over time, the Vegans have built towering arcologies—self-contained superstructures kilometers high—alongside floating cities hovering over the oceans. These structures are designed to maximize efficiency in resource use, regulate heat, and reduce water loss.

Across the Vegan Autonomous District, comprising about 31 worlds, the architectural style features grav-supported superdense towers, highly modular starships, and compartmentalized designs that reflect the clan-like organization of Vegan society. Ships and buildings are often functional and blocky, focusing on efficiency and the collective good over individual aesthetics.

Society, Culture, and the Tuhuir System

At the heart of Vegan life is the **tuhuir**—a cultural institution, philosophy, or unified mindset. Humans sometimes describe tuhuir as tribes, clans, or families, but these comparisons fall short of the deep collective identity shared by Vegan members.

Tuhuir as Social Organization

- Vegan society is divided into hundreds of tuhuir, each with its own customs, traditions, and interpretation of how to live.
- Vegans **do not inherit** tuhuir; instead, as they near sexual maturity, they enter a *search* period—sometimes lasting years—until they choose the tuhuir they will belong to for life. About half ultimately join their parents' tuhuir, while a small percentage (about 0.5%) enjoy the search indefinitely and never settle.

There are three main types of tuhuir:

1. **Civil Service Tuhuir** — Governs the Vegan District, mediates between other tuhuir, and maintains administrative order.
 2. **Interest Clubs** — The majority; organized around interests, philosophies, religions, scientific fields, or cultural pursuits, similar (though more enduring) to the Hiver's "Topical Clubs."
 3. **Rebellious Tuhuir** — Rare, but historically known to exist, occasionally challenging the established order.
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Notable Tuhuir Examples

- **Aushenyo**: Focused on historical study, based at Asterr Tyui.
 - **Ewm Shao Gwi**: A tuhuir resembling a capitalist corporation; it dominates Vegan merchant operations, resource distribution, and interstellar freight.
 - **Gyo Ashui**: Controls major habitats at Gwathi.
 - **Hauarmurr lua**: Devoted to visual arts and artistic expression.
 - **Irriszhia**: Historically pioneered space travel; today it persists as the Vegan Scout Service (*"Star Exploring"*).
 - **Muisstagz Zhia**: Guardian tuhuir, managing police forces and planetary defense (*"Star Guardians"*).
 - **Tsyasha Kwa**: An engineering tuhuir headquartered on Hsuishlesh; known for its design aesthetics, engineering academy, and production of high-quality small civilian starships.
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Historical and Political Background

Archaeological evidence shows that tuhuir once corresponded to geographic regions, much like ancient Earth's countries. Over time, however, they intermixed, forming complex social layers.

When the Vilani First Imperium encountered the Vegans, they mistook the tuhuir for a caste system and imposed similar restrictions. The result was widespread Vegan passive resistance, eventually leading to the Vilani informally allowing Vegans to self-administer within their territories.

Today, the Vegan Autonomous District is a meritocratic, bureaucratic, and peaceful federation of Vegan worlds, governed by the Civil Service tuhuir and renowned for its economic strength, cultural achievements, and technological contributions to the broader interstellar community.

Commercial and Industrial Influence

Among the Vegan tuhuir, **Ewm Shao Gwi** stands out as both a cultural entity and a commercial powerhouse, overseeing much of Vegan interstellar trade and freight operations. Similarly, **Tsyasha Kwa** plays a key role in engineering and starship manufacturing, producing vessels respected across the district for their craftsmanship.

Cultural Character

Vegan society values knowledge, art, peaceful coexistence, and consensus-driven decision-making. Their architecture, social systems, and even ship designs reflect this deeply communal, harmonious worldview, offering players in *Traveller* a rich alien culture to explore, understand, and roleplay.